

Local Ballot Measures: School Bond Measure C

Full Text of Bond Measure

KEY FINDINGS

For generations, Summerville Elementary has had a strong tradition of providing a high-quality education to the students of Tuolumne. Our cherished school currently serves approximately 500 students in transitional kindergarten/kindergarten through eighth grade and provides exceptional educational support in a nurturing and community-based environment. As a school, we believe that "*Together, we can make a difference!"*

We are proud of the high-quality education at Summerville Elementary, but our facilities are aging and in need of repairs and updates. The current school was constructed in 1963, with additions made incrementally over the following sixty years. While maintenance staff do their best to keep classrooms and school facilities safe and clean, our school was built to safety and educational standards from a different era. Basic repairs and upgrades are needed to keep the District's classrooms and facilities safe and functioning for our students.

In recent years, Summerville Elementary leadership conducted a facilities assessment and adopted a comprehensive Facilities Master Plan for our school that identifies priority repairs needed to meet updated security and safety standards. The plan meets the District's goals of providing our students with a safe, up-to-date learning environment to help them succeed in their educational journey.

The facility improvements needed in our Summerville School are far beyond the scope of the District's current maintenance budget. The District is working to gain as much funding for facility upgrades from the State of California (the "State") as possible, but those funds typically take years to receive and will not be sufficient to finance all of the facilities improvements included in the Facilities Master Plan. A school improvement bond measure could provide dedicated local funding to repair and upgrade Summerville School for present and future students.



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This bond measure includes a detailed project list showing how funds are expected to be used, as well as an independent citizens' oversight committee and annual audits to ensure funds are used as promised.

BOND AUTHORIZATION

By approval of this measure by at least 55% of the registered voters voting on the measure, the District will be authorized to issue and sell bonds of up to $3,400,000 in aggregate principal amount, at interest rates not to exceed legal limits and to provide financing for the specific types of school facilities projects listed in the Bond Project List included below, subject to all the accountability requirements specified below.

ACCOUNTABILITY REQUIREMENTS

The provisions in this section are specifically included in this measure in order that the voters and taxpayers in the District may be assured that their money will be spent wisely. Expenditures to address specific facilities needs of the District will be in compliance with the requirements of Article XIIIA, Section 1(b)(3), of the State Constitution and the Strict Accountability in Local School Construction Bonds Act of 2000 (codified at Education Code Sections 15264 and following).

Bonds authorized by this measure may be issued under the provisions of the California Education Code (starting at Section 15100), under the provisions of the California Government Code (starting at Section 53506), or under any other provision of law authorizing the issuance of general obligation bonds by school districts. The bonds may be issued in series by the District, from time to time, and each series of bonds shall mature within the legal limitations set forth in the applicable law under which the bonds are issued.

Evaluation of Needs. The Board of Education of the District (the "Board") has identified detailed facilities needs of the District, and has determined which projects to finance from a local bond. The Board hereby certifies that it has evaluated safety, class size reduction, enrollment growth, and information technology needs in developing the Bond Project List described below.



Independent Citizens' Oversight Committee. Following approval of this measure, the Board will establish an independent citizens' oversight committee, under Education Code Sections 15278 and following, to ensure bond proceeds are expended only on the types of school facilities projects listed below. The committee will be established within 60 days of the date when the results of the election appear in the minutes of the Board.

Performance Audits. The Board will conduct annual, independent performance audits to ensure that the bond proceeds have been expended only on the school facilities projects listed below.

Financial Audits. The Board will conduct annual, independent financial audits of the bond proceeds until all of those proceeds have been spent for the school facilities projects listed below.

Government Code Accountability Requirements. As required by Section 53410 of the Government Code, (1) the specific purpose of the bonds is set forth in this Full Text of the Measure, (2) the proceeds from the sale of the bonds will be used only for the purposes specified in this measure, and not for any other purpose, (3) the proceeds of the bonds, when and if issued, will be deposited into a building fund to be held by the Tuolumne County Treasurer, as required by the Education Code, and (4) the Superintendent of the District shall cause an annual report to be filed with the Board of the District not later than January 1 of each year, which report shall contain pertinent information regarding the amount of funds collected and expended, as well as the status of the projects listed in this measure, as required by Sections 53410 and 53411 of the Government Code.

Bonding Capacity. Issuance of each series of bonds authorized by this measure is required to conform with all applicable legal requirements. This includes issuance within applicable bonding capacity limitations, which may include a waiver of bonding capacity granted by the State Board of Education, if sought and granted.

NO TEACHER OR ADMINISTRATOR SALARIES

Proceeds from the sale of bonds authorized by this measure shall be used only for the purposes specified in Article XIII A, Section 1(b)(3), specifically the construction,

reconstruction, rehabilitation, or replacement of school facilities, including the furnishing and equipping of school facilities, and the acquisition or lease of school facilities, and not for any other purpose, including teacher and administrator salaries and other school operating expenses.

INFORMATION ABOUT ESTIMATES AND PROJECTIONS INCLUDED IN BALLOT

Voters are informed that any estimates or projections in the bond measure or ballot materials, including relating to estimated tax rates, the duration of issued bonds, and related tax levies and collections, are provided as informational only. Such amounts are estimates and are not maximum amounts or limitations on the terms of the bonds, the tax rate, or duration of the tax supporting repayment of issued bonds. Such estimates depend on numerous variables which are subject to variation and change over the term of the District's overall facilities and bond financing plan, including but not limited to the amount of bonds issued and outstanding at any one time, the interest rates applicable to issued bonds, market conditions at the time of sale of the bonds, when bonds mature, timing of project needs and changes in assessed valuations in the District. As such, while such estimates and approximations are provided based on information currently available to the District and its current expectations, such estimates and approximations are not limitations and are not binding upon the District. In addition, the abbreviated and condensed statement of the bond measure presented to voters, which is subject to a word count limitation imposed by State law, does not limit the scope and complete meaning of the measure provided in this Full Text of Bond Measure and related ballot materials.

BOND PROJECT LIST

Scope of Projects. Bond proceeds will be expended on the modernization, renovation, expansion, acquisition, construction, reconstruction, rehabilitation or replacement of school facilities of the District, including the furnishing and equipping of school facilities.

School Facility Project List. The items presented on the following list are the specific school facilities projects authorized to be financed with voter-approved bond proceeds. The projects are authorized at Summerville Elementary School:



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- Repair aging and deteriorating classrooms, restrooms and school facilities at Buildings A and B, including HVAC, aging plumbing, sewer and electrical lines, interior renovations and finishes, ceiling and lighting upgrades, and improving walkways and student accessibility related to projects at Buildings A and B
- Repair or replace leaky roofs at Buildings A and B
- Upgrade campus-wide fire, safety, and security systems, including fire alarms, communication and surveillance systems, and exterior lighting
- Upgrade school grounds to prevent flooding, including storm drain and asphalt repair and replacement related to these repairs and updates

Incidental Expenses. Each of the bond projects described in this Bond Project List includes the costs of furnishing and equipping such facilities, and all costs which are incidental but directly related to the types of projects described above. Examples of incidental costs include, but are not limited to: costs of design, engineering, architect and other professional services, facilities assessments, inspections, site preparation, utilities, landscaping, interior and exterior painting, bond project construction management, administration and other planning and permitting, legal, accounting and similar costs; independent annual financial and performance audits; a customary construction contingency; abatement, demolition and disposal of existing structures; the costs of interim housing and storage during construction including relocation and construction costs incurred relating to interim facilities; the preparation or restoration of construction, renovation or remodeling; rental or construction of storage facilities and other space on an interim basis for materials and other equipment and furnishings displaced during construction; costs of relocating facilities and equipment as needed in connection with the projects; the acquisition or improvement of interim classrooms and facilities for students, administrators, and school functions, including portable classrooms and other modular facilities; federal and state-mandated safety upgrades; addressing unforeseen conditions revealed by construction/modernization and other necessary improvements required to comply with existing building codes, including the Field Act; access requirements of the Americans with Disabilities Act; and costs of the election; bond issuance costs; and project administration during the duration of such projects, as permitted by law.

Furnishing and Equipping. Each project is assumed to include its share of furniture, fixtures, and equipment; architectural, engineering, and similar planning costs, program/project management, staff training expenses, and a customary contingency for unforeseen design and construction costs. In addition to the listed projects stated above, the list also includes the acquisition of a variety of instructional, maintenance and operational equipment; installation of signage and fencing; payment of the costs of preparation of all facility planning, facility studies, assessment reviews, facility master plan preparation and updates, environmental studies (including environmental investigation, remediation and monitoring), design and construction documentation, and temporary housing of dislocated District activities caused by construction projects. The upgrading of technology infrastructure includes, but is not limited to, computers, projectors, portable interface devices, servers, switches, routers, modules, sound projection systems, printers, digital white boards, document projectors, telephone systems, call manager, and network security/firewall, wireless technology systems, and other miscellaneous equipment.

Alterations to Scope. The scope and nature of any of the specific projects described above may be altered by the District as required by conditions that may arise during the course of design and construction. In the event that a modernization or renovation project is more economical for or otherwise determined by the Board to be in the best interests of the District to be undertaken as new construction, this bond measure authorizes said new construction including land acquisition, relocation and construction at a new or alternative site, and/or demolition and reconstruction and/or repurposing on the original site, including an expanded site, and all costs relating thereto.

Bond Project List Not in Order of Priority; Board Determines Prioritization. Approval of this bond measure does not guarantee that the proposed projects will be funded beyond the local revenues generated by the measure. The District's capital needs currently exceed the amount of bonds the voters are being asked to authorize. The order in which particular projects are listed is not intended to suggest priority for funding or completion, and itemization of projects in the list above does not guarantee that all such projects will be undertaken. Project priorities will be determined by the Board. The ability of the District to undertake and complete the listed projects is subject to numerous variables, including the adequacy and availability of sufficient funding sources. The District is unable to anticipate all unforeseen circumstances that may prevent some of the projects listed above from being undertaken or completed.



Interpretation. The terms of this bond measure and the words used in the Bond Project List shall be interpreted broadly to effect the purpose of providing broad and clear authority for the officers and employees of the District to provide for the school facilities projects the District proposes to finance with the proceeds of the sale of bonds authorized by this proposition within the authority provided by law, including Article XIIIA, Section 1(b)(3) of the California Constitution, Education Code Section 15000 *et seq.* and the Strict Accountability in Local School Construction Bonds Act of 2000. Words used in the Bond Project List, such as repair, improve, upgrade, expand, modernize, renovate, and reconfigure, are used to describe school facilities projects in plain English but are not intended to expand the nature of such projects beyond what is authorized by law. As such, in accordance with legal requirements, the Bond Project List does not authorize, and shall not be interpreted to authorize, expending proceeds of the sale of bonds authorized by this proposition for current maintenance, operation, or repairs.

Severability. The Board hereby declares, and the voters by approving this Bond Measure concur, that every section and part of this bond proposition has independent value, and the Board and the voters would have adopted each provision hereof regardless of every other provision hereof. Upon approval of this measure by the voters, should any part be found by a court of competent jurisdiction to be invalid for any reason, all remaining parts hereof shall remain in full force and effect to the fullest extent allowed by law, and to this end, the provisions of this bond measure are severable.